

M.2 ports channeled via different PCIe lines. Some might be sourced directly from the CPU, some might go through an intermediary multiplexor chip or some might be coming from the PCH. With the ASUS HYPER M.2 x16 CARD, all that is taken care of and you can have four of the best performing SSDs on the planet in RAID 0.

SSD - 4X SAMSUNG 960 PRO 2TB

Speaking of the best performing consumer SSD. We don't have to look far. Samsung 960 Pro series sits at the apex of all benchmarking charts. We're going with the 2 TB SKU which among the 960 Pro series, has the highest transfer speeds. Using four of these gives us a sequential transfer rate of over 13.2 GB/s!

You might be wondering, why not Optane? Well, Optane is a really impressive technology, but we'd rather let it mature a little before opting for Optane. And the fact that current gen Optane consumer SSDs are drastically limited in space, means you don't get enough space even with four of them in RAID 0. The enterprise grade P4800 would be a good choice, but as we mentioned in the beginning, we're sticking to consumer grade components only.

RAM - 2X G.SKILL TRIDENT Z F4-4200C19Q2-64GTZKK

There isn't much to say about commodities so we aren't going to. This particular kit was chosen for the high bandwidth and the texture which goes well with the overall colour scheme of the build. We're opting for two kits which total to 128 GB of storage space. It's quite overkill but if you were to start off with some heavy duty video editing or run some machine learning workloads then you're all set.

HDD - 2X WD BLACK 6 TB

When you don't want to store something on an SSD, you need an HDD. And if we're going to be looking at a high performing HDD, then the WD Black comes to mind. These are not only high RPM drives but should they ever fail then WD Black drives come with longer than average warranties.

GRAPHICS CARD - 2X NVIDIA GTX TITAN XP

Yes, we know NVIDIA doesn't advertise the TITAN Xp for gaming but we aren't

building a pure gaming system to begin with. It's an all purpose card with focus on computing but you can game as well. And guess what, it performs better than the GTX 1080 Ti when it comes to gaming! And yes, NVIDIA has several libraries that allow you to use the CUDA cores on the GTX TITAN Xp as accelerators so you're getting a pretty great multi-purpose graphics card.

PSU - CORSAIR AX1200i

We have two power hungry components in this build, the Core i9-7980XE and the TITAN Xp cards in SLI will consume in excess of 600 Watts. Should you overclock the 7980XE, then you're looking at an even greater draw. So we needed a power supply that can not only handle an SLI configuration but also give you the option of scaling. Corsair's Link feature is exactly that. If you wish to have a more extravagant setup, then you can opt for the Corsair AX1500i though we believe that the AX1200i should more more than sufficient.

CABINET - ENTHOO ELITE

In order to get the best possible components for this rig, you will have to get a few things imported and one of them is the cabinet. Phanteks does not have an official presence in India, so getting this case will take some time, but it'll be worth the wait. The Enthoo Elite, like most competitors, has a tempered glass panel on one of the side but its selling point is the presence of USB Type-C + 4x USB 3.0 ports on the front I/O, and 5x good quality Phanteks Premium fans which are included and the amazing build quality. The exterior is 4mm thick aluminum panels, and the overall chassis design incorporates two zones allowing you to isolate the liquid cooling radiator and hard drives into a lower bay while all the remaining components stay in the main bay.

Should you not want to get the Enthoo Elite, then there's always the Corsair 900D or Cooler Master COSMOS II.

MONITOR - ACER XB272 27-INCH 240 HZ TN

Monitors with 240 Hz refresh rate are a rarity at the moment and you're stuck with FHD resolution since scaling it up would require more bandwidth. The Acer XB272 has the advantage of having

the sweet spot because of its 27-inch size. Any greater and you'd start noticing the pixels easily, any smaller and it just feels incomplete. You get an ample amount of I/O options but it's always advisable to use the DisplayPort since that's the only way you can enable G-Sync. If you've been wowed by 144 Hz displays, the 240 Hz displays will appear even smoother. Moreover, the 2x TITAN Xp cards should easily provide 240 FPS in most games, so G-sync will be a treat on the XB272.

KEYBOARD - CORSAIR K95 RGB PLATINUM

MOUSE - LOGITECH G900 CHAOS SPECTRUM

CONTROLLERS - XBOX ONE S CONTROLLER,

SAITEK X-55 RHINO HOTAS,

THRUSTMASTER T500 RS

And now, we come to the more subjective elements of the build. Always go with what every keyboard and mouse you're most comfortable with, even if it happens to be a cheap ₹300 keyboard from your local mom-n-pop computer shop. But if you're open to trying out a more ergonomic and well designed keyboard and mouse, then the Corsair K95 RGB Platinum and Logitech G900 are our recommendations.

Then there are the other controllers. These come into play in very specific scenarios, mostly gaming. For example, the Xbox One S controller is great for platformer games and even for the more hardcore games like *Dark Souls*. And then there are racing and flight sims. If you want a more enriching experience, then getting a Thrustmaster T500 RS will completely change racing sims for you. And the same goes for flight sims with the Saitek X-55 Rhino HOTAS.

BRING ON THE PITCHFORKS!

Coming up with PC configurations has always been exciting, especially when you have like-minded individuals to argue with. So, there's no doubt that you've got a few changes that you'd like to make with this configuration. And we're all ears. **d**